



As the desktop processor segment continues to evolve, several key trends have emerged, some more exciting than others. Intel's strategic decision to retain the 700 series chipsets for their 14th Generation launch represented a consumer-centric approach, making it easier for users to upgrade. AMD is not far behind in the innovation race. Their Zen 5 microarchitecture, codenamed Nirvana, targets a substantial 10% improvement in IPC, indicating a leap in processing efficiency. Furthermore, AMD's Zen 6 is poised to revolutionise processor design with extensive die-stacking technologies. Both giants, Intel and AMD, are keen on integrating AI capabilities across their product lines, a move that could redefine processor functionality and application. And now, onto the winners this year.

Zero1 Award Winner: AMD Ryzen 9 7950X3D

In a close contest, the AMD Ryzen 9 7950X3D emerged as the winner. Its performance closely rivals that of the Intel Core i9-14900K, with AMD edging out Intel in several key workloads. While Intel maintains a slight lead in some single-threaded applications, AMD has made significant strides, overtaking Intel in areas where they traditionally dominated. This shift is particularly evident in gaming benchmarks, where the AMD Ryzen 9 7950X3D shows a clear lead, and it pushed even further ahead. One of the

Desktop Processors

Power-performance status quo



AMD Ryzen 9 7950X3D
Price: ₹65,699

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2023



AMD Ryzen 7 7800X3D
Price: ₹37,500

decisive factors for AMD's triumph is its processors' power efficiency. While Intel's processors have become more power-hungry, AMD has managed to maintain, and even improve, efficiency. This balance of power and performance is what ultimately crowned AMD Ryzen 9 7950X3D as the top performer.

Runner-Up: Intel Core i9-14900K

The Intel Core i9-14900K stands as the runner-up in this competitive landscape. In our tests Intel was ahead in productivity benchmarks and a lot of content creation benchmarks as well but it took a beating in gaming and power efficiency. Among this generation, the Intel Core i7-14700K emerged as a particularly impressive model. However, the Intel Core i9-14900K, despite its advancements, is marked by its high power consumption. In our tests, this is one aspect where the competition raced ahead and lost Intel the crown this year. So it goes without saying that power-efficiency is what Intel should be focused on for the next generation of processors.



Intel Core i9-14900K
Price: ₹55,840

Best Buy: AMD Ryzen 7 7800X3D

When it comes to value for money, the AMD Ryzen 7 7800X3D stands out as the best buy. Excelling in gaming, it even surpasses the AMD Ryzen 9 7950X3D in certain titles, a testament to its optimisation for high-performance gaming that doesn't simply rely on a high core count. The incorporation of 3D V-Cache which we first saw on the Ryzen 7 5800X3D has proven to be a game-changer for this processor and its siblings, providing a significant boost in gaming performance. This technology will, hopefully, be more prevalent in the next generation across price points. Beyond gaming, the Ryzen 7 7800X3D is also great at content creation and daily productivity tasks, making it an all-rounder. Its pricing and performance synergy make it an undeniable choice for consumers seeking the best bang for their buck.

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